

Alp Niksarli

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Education

Davidson College (Columbia University 3+2)

Expected May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Data Science (GPA: 3.84)

Davidson, NC

- **Relevant Coursework:** Deep RL, ML Systems, RL for LLMs, Generative Models, Adv. Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing (TA), Computer Security, Vector Calculus, Theory of Computation, Discrete Structures

Work Experience

Google Maps

May 2026 – Present

(AI/ML) Software Engineering Intern

San Francisco, CA

- Building agent monitoring and user telemetry infrastructure for Ask Maps, a state-of-the-art agentic Maps feature
- Designing evaluation sets and an automated experimentation harness, driving an estimated 35% hillclimb over evals
- Leveraging dedicated 20% time to contribute to high-priority AI projects with Gemini App and NotebookLM teams

Amazon Lab126

May 2025 – Aug 2025

(AI/ML) Software Development Engineer Intern

Sunnyvale, CA

- Engineered sandboxes and client-side browsers to simulate and detect browser-use agents for Amazon's retail site
- Re-architected team infrastructure using AWS CDK, reducing future manual configuration effort by 80%
- Hacked with the AGI team to build a multimodal AI assistant, projected 26% boost in developer productivity
- Organized the largest in-person hackathon in Amazon w/ 200 intern registrations, got invited to AGI SVP's office

Fiverr - [fiverr.com/alpnix](https://www.fiverr.com/alpnix)

Sep 2021 – August 2024

Freelance ML Engineer

Remote

- Worked with 51 clients from all around the world on web scraping/automation and data science projects and gigs
- Developed a natural language processing (NLP) algorithm for sentiment analysis on chat messages of 80,000+ users
- Assisted the migration of database systems from MongoDB to Elasticsearch, boosted query efficiency by 200%

Projects

LLM Safety Research in University of Edinburgh's Generative AI Laboratory | [HuggingFace](#), [PyTorch](#), [Redis](#), [WebArena](#), [LLMs](#)

- Evaluated long-horizon agent performance on tasks like coding, navigation, and information retrieval, trying to improve the 24% agent success rate by improvements on planning, retrieval and memory
- Worked on a multiturn context augmentation framework to save, retrieve and rerank key info from task completions

GroTn | [AWS Lambda & SQS](#), [Langchain](#), [Pinecone](#), [TypeScript](#), [Next.js](#), [Stripe](#), [MongoDB](#)

- Scraped millions of housing listings and generated vector embeddings to power a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) rental search engine with sub-1200 ms query latency and worked on system design
- Reached 500+ users, awarded over \$10,000 through pitching, and interviewed 70 engineers to build a team

Pragma | [Pytorch](#), [CUDA](#), [OpenAI](#), [Supabase](#), [BeautifulSoup](#)

- Built a full RAG Pipeline with Google Search API and Ragas, ensuring state-of-the-art performance in data accuracy
- Automated 2 GB of research data collection from the web across departments like sociology or education studies

Cats' Courses | [Azure](#), [Python](#), [Flask](#), [Firebase](#), [Twilio](#), [SMTP](#)

- Reverse engineered API endpoints to sent email notifications to Davidson students for spots in their desired classes
- More than half of the campus adopted the app within 2 weeks, I was given a position with college's IT team

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, PyTorch, SQL, Go, Next.js, Java, TensorFlow, Django

Dev Tools: LLMs, Hugging Face, AWS, NumPy, Git, MySQL, CUDA, JAX, Postgres, Pinecone, Docker, APIs, Langchain, Vim

Awards

Academic: 4th place in Turkish National Research Competition ([Paper](#)); Placed top 700 out of 1,200,000 high school students in the Turkish National Exam (0.05%); Bonner Scholarship; Xerox Award for Innovation & Information Technology

Hackathons: [Optiver Winner](#) in Ada Hacks, [Best AI project](#) in HackHarvard; [1st place and Best use of Defang](#) in VandyHacks; [Best Generative AI project](#) in HackNC; [Best use of Taipy](#) in HopHacks; 1st place in Earthquake Relief Hackathon ([Patent Pending](#)); Top 5 out of 782 projects in Uber Global Hackathon; Led Hack@Davidson (\$20k in funding)